
Assignment 3: Dissertation 481

Introduction

Research is a structured, disciplined and systematic process aimed at discovering new knowledge, validating existing theories, solving problems, or answering specific questions. This process can be thought of as consisting of two phases namely, **WHAT** the research is about and **HOW** to execute the research.

Objectives of the assignment

The primary objective of this assignment is to:

- Identify the most appropriate research approach (design) to meet the objectives or to test the hypothesis.
- Describe the data sources, data gathering and the data analysis methods.

Research Methods

The aim of research is to journey for a position of not knowing something to knowing something. The research problem represents a statement of this state of not knowing something. As such it captures a kind of 'wrongness' in need of solving. The research question in turn allows us to ask a question about this state such that an answer will provide the solution. The objective/s are statements of action that once completed will serve as the answer to a research question. The hypothesis serves much the same function as the objectives except that it represents testable statements.

Your task

In this assignment, you are required to design and write the complete Methodology chapter of your research project. The chapter should demonstrate your understanding of research design principles and how they are applied in Information Technology research. You are expected to clearly articulate how your study will be conducted, justify your methodological choices, and ensure alignment with your research problem, objectives, and questions.

Additional Information

- Do this assignment as an individual. You can collaborate with your peers for discussions and brainstorming but the write-up should be done alone.
- Late assignments will not be accepted and all the candidates who will submit this assignment late will get a zero (0).

- Marks will be awarded according to the rubric below.

Marking guide

Description	Mark
Clarity of research design and alignment with objectives	20
Justification of research paradigm and methodology	15
Description and appropriateness of design, data collection, and analysis tools and techniques.	30
Consideration of validity, reliability/trustworthiness	10
Use of literature to support methodology	15
Academic writing and structure + referencing (Harvard or required style)	10
TOTAL	100